

first position of a Lisp form."

```
(defmacro new-name (&rest args)
  '(', 'old-name, @args)))
```

DEFSYNONYM

```
> (defsynonym make-pair cons)
```

MAKE-PAIR

```
> (make-pair 'a 'b)
```

(A . B)

Macros are always a little bit dangerous because code containing a macro call does not automatically get updated if you change the definition of the macro. You can always establish your own convention to help you remember that you need to recompile certain code after you change a macro definition. But there's always the possibility that you'll forget, or make a mistake.

Ultimately, the likelihood that you'll inadvertently end up with code that was compiled with an old version of a macro is directly proportional to how often you're likely to change the macro. A macro like *defsynonym* practically begs to be used again and again as you generate new code. If you change your mind about the old name to associate with a given new name, all of your

previously compiled code will still refer to the old name that you had decided upon earlier.

I'll leave you here to have fun with your macros.

In the next article, we'll take a peek into Common Lisp Object System (CLOS) which allows you to build very sophisticated object-based systems. If you care to code with a strongly object-oriented mindset, you will probably find all the OOP language functionality you need in Common Lisp. CLOS has many advanced object-oriented features that you won't find in many other places. Because of this, CLOS has often been used as a research tool for studying OOP ideas. **END** 

By: Vivek Shangari

The author is a hard-core hacker, if ever there was one. He always thinks programs, and holds a piece of code in his head all the time. His favourite past time is to stop random strangers on the street and start talking about the benefits of open source over proprietary software, till they agree to switch sides, or threaten to jump off the nearest building. Every now and then, he manages to talk a bunch of unsuspecting potential programmers into letting him train them in Lisp. It's not rare to find people stumble out after the training session "zombified", or with tears running down their faces. "Those are tears of joy!" he will patiently explain. For those of you out there who cannot be deterred, you can reach him at vivek@codeCraft.in.

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Cyber Futuristics India (P) Ltd.

Noida: SDF G-13/14, NSEZ, Phase II, Nodia-05 (U.P.)
Phone: 0120-666-7793, Mob: 9717444822, 9212413966

For Partner Enquiry: partners@cyfuture.com

For Sales Enquiry: sales@go4hosting.com

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